Ford Motor Company

December 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 00S45: Certain 2001 Model Year Ranger, Explorer Sport, and Explorer Sport Trac Vehicles – Hood Latch Striker Replacement

AFFECTED VEHICLES

- Certain 2001 model year Ranger 4x4 XLT, 4x2 Edge and 4x4 Edge vehicles equipped with sheet molding compound (SMC) hoods and built at the Edison Assembly Plant and the Twin Cities Assembly Plant from Job #1, 2000 to September 15, 2000.
- All 2001 model year Explorer Sport and Explorer Sport Trac vehicles built from Job #1, 2000 to October 17, 2000

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles, the hood latch striker may crack, potentially allowing the hood to fly-up and obstruct the driver's view.

SERVICE ACTION

Dealers are to replace the existing hood striker with a revised one. This must be done on all of the affected vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 00S45
Certain 2001 Model Year Ranger, Explorer Sport, and Explorer Sport Trac Vehicles
Hood Latch Striker Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental cars are not provided for this program.

Safety Recall 00S45
Certain 2001 Model Year Ranger, Explorer Sport, and Explorer Sport Trac Vehicles
Hood Latch Striker Replacement

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Remove and Replace hood latch striker	00S45B	0.3 Hrs.
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-325-5621
Emergency Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
XL5Z-16K689-AA	Striker Assembly – Hood Lock	1

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50198 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

December 2000

00S45

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect that relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2001 model year Ranger, Explorer Sport, and Explorer Sport Trac Vehicles.

What the safety issue is …	In some of the affected vehicles, the hood latch striker may crack, potentially allowing the hood to fly-up and obstruct the driver's view.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do . . .	Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for a hood striker replacement.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.
What we are asking you to do …	Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S45. If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering. When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.
If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …	Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

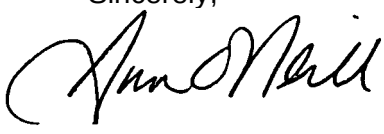
Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs